TPPA PAYMENTS

Overview and first steps

What TPPA Payments is, how its parts fit together, the roles, and which guide to read.

For: Everyone who uses TPPA Payments, and IT

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The screenshots come from a demonstration system: every name, account, amount and code in them is made up.

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1. About this guide

This guide is for everyone who works with TPPA Payments: head office, branch staff, kiosk custodians and IT. Read it first. It explains:

- what the system is and how its parts work together;
- the six roles, what each one does, and which guide to read next;
- a normal day, from the morning to the day end;
- the words used on the screens and in the other guides (the glossary);
- the security rules every user follows.

The screenshots come from a demonstration system. Every name, account, amount, OR number and code in them is made up.

2. What TPPA Payments is

TPPA Payments is the system Trans Pilipinas Power & Automation Inc. (TPPA) uses to collect bill payments for utilities such as Davao Light (DLP) and Davao City Water District (DCWD). It has four parts.

Part	Where it runs	Who uses it	What it does
Head-office console	A web browser, at the console address	Head office, branch managers, kiosk custodians (read only)	Set-up (branches, users, terminals, utilities, fees, receipt layouts), daily reports, collection files, exceptions, kiosks, audit log, alert emails
Teller app	A Windows PC at each branch counter, with an Epson LX-310 receipt printer	Tellers and branch managers	Takes payments (cash, cheque, debit card), prints official receipts, voids, kiosk credit refunds, the opening float and the day end
Kiosk app	A self-service kiosk	Customers; kiosk custodians in staff mode	Takes exact cash for a bill, prints the receipt on a thermal roll, closes its own day at midnight
Central server	The head-office server (one address)	Everything above talks to it	Keeps every record, checks every payment again, makes the reports and files, sends the alert emails

The terminals work offline

A teller PC or a kiosk is called a **terminal**. Each one keeps its own encrypted copy of what it needs (fees, receipt layout, OR numbers, staff) and of everything it records. When the network is down it keeps working: payments, receipts, voids and the day end all work offline. The status bar of the teller app then reads "Offline: work is saved and sent later".

When the network is back, the terminal sends what it recorded and fetches new settings by itself (every 15 seconds while online). This is called **sync**. Head office sees a payment only after the terminal has sent it.

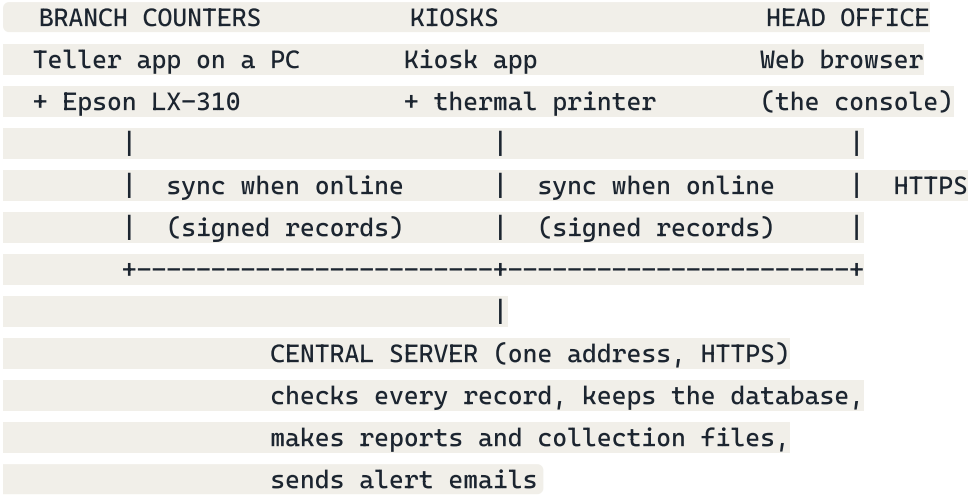
Receipts and OR numbers

Every payment gets an **official receipt** with its own **OR number**, for example 0001-01-00000005: the branch code (0001), the terminal code (01) and a running number. The numbers come from an **OR series** that head office opens for each terminal. A number is used once and never again, even when the receipt is voided. A reprint is marked REPRINTED.

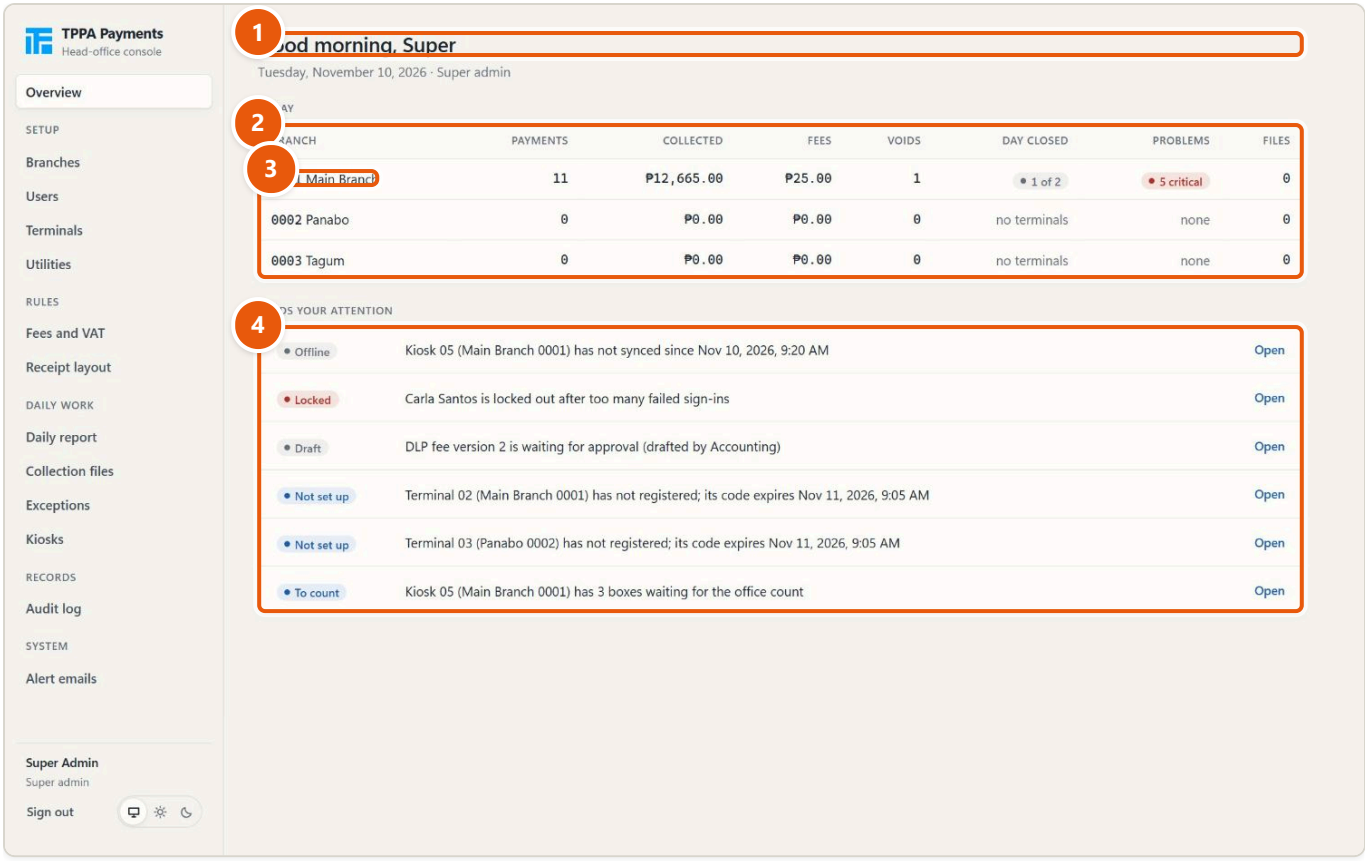
Collection files for the utilities

Each day, for each branch and each utility, the console makes the **collection files** the utility receives: a .TXT and a .RPT file, for example TPPA01DLPC00000120261110CLF.TXT for Davao Light. They are made once every terminal of the branch has closed the day (the D18 rule, see the glossary). The service fees TPPA charges are never in these files.

3. How the parts fit together



- Head office sets things up in the console: branches, users, utilities, fees, receipt layouts, terminals and their OR series.
- Each terminal downloads those settings and works from them, online or offline.
- Each terminal sends back every payment, void, reprint, cash count and Z-reading. The server checks each one again (the fee, the OR number, who approved) and lists anything that does not add up on the **Exceptions** page.
- Head office then sees the day in the console: the Overview, the Daily report, the Collection files and the Kiosks page.



1. Greeting, date and your role
2. Today, per branch
3. Opens that branch's daily report
4. Needs your attention, most urgent first

The console's Overview: today per branch, and what needs attention first.

4. The roles

Everyone signs in with their own account. The role of the account decides what the person sees and may do; the server refuses the rest, whatever the screen shows. Branch managers, tellers and kiosk custodians belong to one branch and see only that branch.

Role	What this role does	Where	Read
Super admin	Everything an admin does, and also creates and changes admins and other super admins. Two-step sign-in is required.	Console	Super admin guide (01)
Admin	Sets the system up: branches, users (not administrators), terminals and OR series, utilities, fees and VAT, receipt layouts, alert emails. Approves fee versions and receipt layouts. Daily work: reports, collection files, exceptions, kiosks (take one out of service, count a collected cash box).	Console; staff mode at a kiosk	Admin guide (02)
Accounting	Reports, collection files (once every terminal has closed), exceptions, audit log. Drafts fee versions and receipt layouts for an admin to approve. Counts the cash boxes collected from kiosks.	Console	Accounting guide (03)

Role	What this role does	Where	Read
Branch manager	Approves at the counter with their own password: voids, cash differences at the day end, corrections of the opening float, kiosk credit refunds. Can take payments too. Sees the branch's daily report, collection files (and may make them early, with a reason), exceptions and audit log. Looks after the branch's kiosks.	Teller app; console; staff mode at a kiosk	Branch manager guide (04), Teller guide (05)
Teller	Takes payments at a counter, reprints receipts, asks for voids, refunds kiosk credit slips, records the opening float, counts the drawer and closes the day.	Teller app	Teller guide (05)
Kiosk custodian	Looks after the kiosks of the branch in staff mode: collects the cash box, loads paper, reprints, prints the readings, tests the acceptors, takes the kiosk out of service and back. Sees the branch's kiosks in the console (read only).	Kiosk (staff mode); console	Kiosk custodian guide (06)

Two more guides are for everyone:

- **Kiosk guide (07):** how a customer pays at a kiosk and how the kiosk behaves.
- **Troubleshooting guide (08):** what to do when something is not right, and who to call.

IT reads the **IT and set-up guide (09)**: installing and registering terminals and kiosks, and the server.

5. A day in the life

Morning

At the counter. The teller signs in to the teller app with their own username and password. Before the first payment the app asks for the **opening float**: the change fund counted in the drawer. The status bar shows whether the terminal is online, whether anything is waiting to sync, the printer state and how many OR numbers are left.

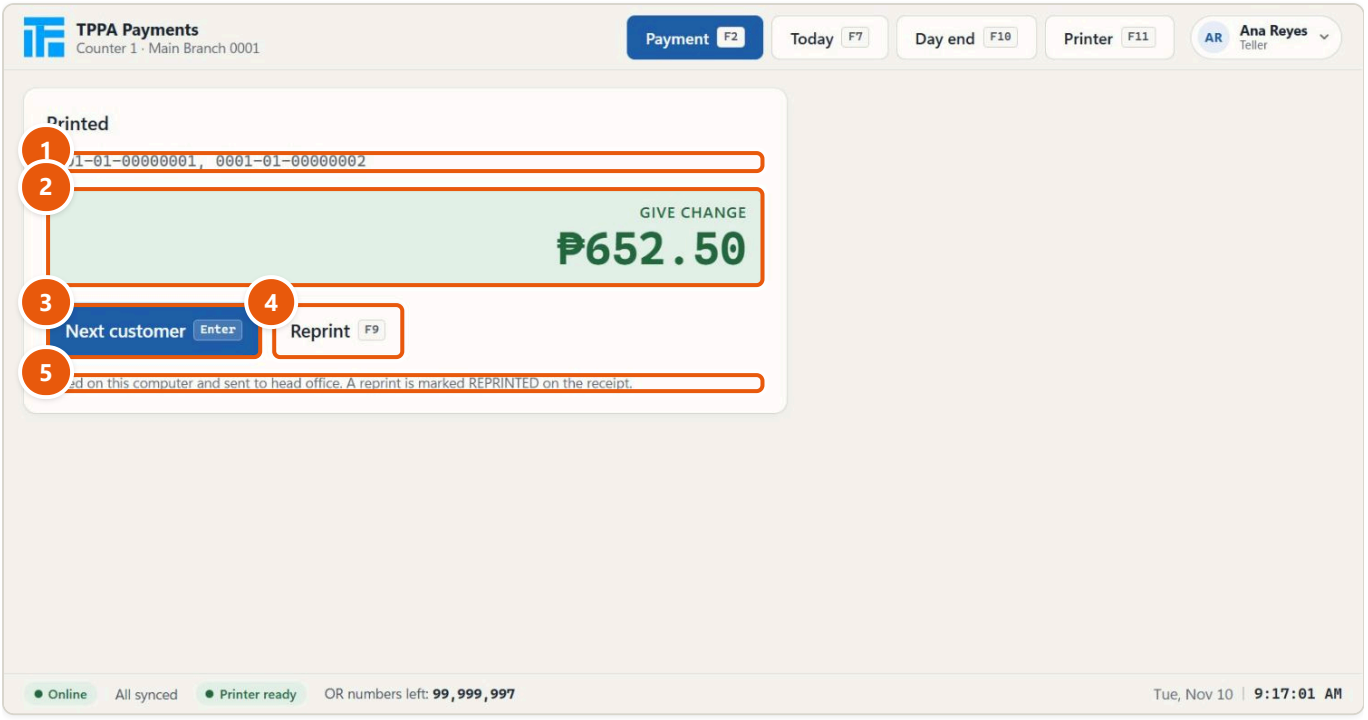
At the kiosk. The kiosk closed the previous day by itself at midnight (Manila time). It shows the start screen, ready for customers. The custodian checks it in staff mode when needed: paper, the cash box, faults.

At head office. An admin or Accounting opens the console. The **Overview** lists what needs attention, most urgent first: a kiosk out of service or not heard from, a locked user, a draft fee waiting for approval, a terminal not set up yet, kiosk cash boxes to count. The daily report email of the previous business day arrives from 7:00 AM Manila time.

During the day

- **Counter:** the teller enters the account ID and name from the bill, the amount, then the payment (cash, cheque or debit card), and prints the receipt. A customer can pay several bills at once; each gets its own receipt.
- **Voids:** a wrong receipt is voided with the branch manager's approval, given on the teller's screen with the manager's own password.

- **Kiosk credits:** when a customer at a kiosk inserts cash but the payment cannot finish (for example the customer leaves), the kiosk prints a **kiosk credit slip**. The customer brings it to a counter; the teller refunds it with the branch manager's approval.
- **Kiosk cash:** the custodian collects the full cash box in staff mode; the kiosk prints a collection slip. At the office, someone other than the collector counts the box and enters the count in the console.
- **Head office:** watches the Overview and the Kiosks page, and resolves exceptions as they come.

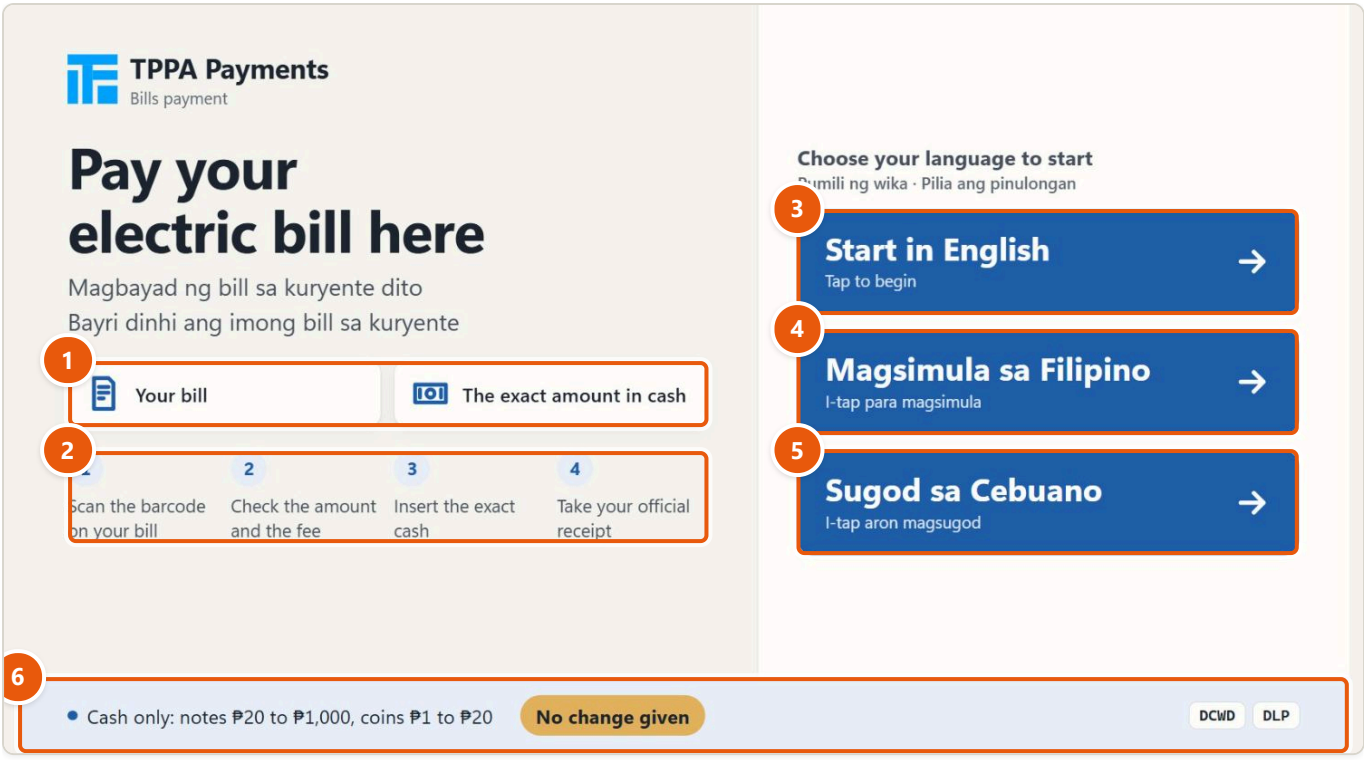


1. The OR numbers printed
2. Give change
3. Next customer (Enter)
4. Reprint (F9)
5. Saved and sent to head office

The teller app after a payment: the OR numbers, the change to give, and "Saved and sent to head office".

Day end

- **Counter:** the teller opens **Day end** (`F10`), counts the drawer by bill and coin, checks the figures and closes the day. The app works out the cash expected: the opening float plus the cash taken, less any kiosk credits refunded. If the count is short or over, the branch manager approves the difference on the same screen. Closing records the **Z-reading**; after that the terminal takes no more payments that day (reprints still work).
- **Kiosk:** the kiosk closes its day by itself at midnight and records its Z-reading. There is no drawer to count: its cash is counted when the box is collected.
- **Head office:** once every terminal of a branch has closed the day and synced, the **collection files** are made for each utility and downloaded. The **Daily report** shows each terminal's Z-reading, cash and difference. **Exceptions** shows anything that does not add up.



1. What to bring: the bill and the exact cash
2. The four steps
3. Start in English
4. Start in Filipino
5. Start in Cebuano
6. Cash rules: notes, coins, no change

The kiosk's start screen: the customer chooses a language and starts.

6. Key ideas and glossary

Word	What it means
OR number	The number of an official receipt, for example 0001-01-00000005 (branch, terminal, running number). Used once, never reused, also when the receipt is voided.
OR series	The range of OR numbers head office opens for one terminal, as on its BIR permit (for example 1 to 99,999,999). The teller app shows "OR numbers left"; when few are left it adds ": tell head office". When the series is used up, head office opens the next one.
Fee schedule, fee version	The service fee TPPA charges for a utility, with its VAT treatment. Each change is a new **version**: drafted (by Accounting or an admin), approved by an admin, and in force from its **effective time**. An approved version never changes.
Effective time	When an approved fee version or receipt layout takes effect. Later versions need notice (at least one hour by default) so that offline terminals receive them first.
Z-reading	The record of a closed day on one terminal: ORs issued, totals by payment method, voids, reprints, kiosk credits refunded, opening float, cash expected and counted. Head office receives it; the teller can print it as often as needed.
X-reading	The same figures for the day so far, without closing the day. At a kiosk it is printed in staff mode ("Print today so far").
Opening float	The change fund in the drawer at the start of the day. Recorded once; a correction needs the branch manager.

Word	What it means
Cash count	At the day end, the number of each bill and coin in the drawer. Compared with the cash expected.
Void	Cancelling a receipt that was wrong. It needs a reason and the branch manager's approval. The OR number stays used. A day that is closed can no longer be voided at the counter.
Reprint	A second copy of a receipt, marked REPRINTED, with its count. Reprints still work after the day is closed.
Kiosk credit	Cash a kiosk kept but could not turn into a payment. The kiosk prints a slip with a code such as KC-434U-VGR9 (not an official receipt). It is refunded once, at a TPPA counter, with a branch manager's approval, and needs the network.
Collection file, batch	The files a utility receives for one branch, one day: a .TXT and a .RPT. Each time they are made they get a new **batch number**. If payments change afterwards (a late payment or a void), they are made again: a new batch, and the earlier one is kept as superseded.
D18 rule	Collection files are made once every terminal of the branch has closed the day. Before that, only a branch manager or an admin may make them, with a reason, and the files are marked "Made before every terminal closed".
Exception and check	On the Exceptions page, a **problem reported by sync** is something a terminal sent that does not add up (for example a cash difference, a fee that does not match). It stays open until someone resolves it with a note. A **check for this day** is worked out live (for example a kiosk box not counted yet) and clears by itself. Severities read Critical, Check or Info.
Step-up	Before a sensitive change in the console (for example creating a user or a terminal), the console asks for your password again: "Confirm it is you". It does not ask again for 10 minutes on that device.
Two-step sign-in	After the password, a 6-digit code from an authenticator app on your phone. Required for super admins; head office may require it for admins too. Recovery codes work once each if the phone is lost.
Terminal registration	Connecting a new teller PC or kiosk to head office with a **one-time code** from the console: 12 letters and digits, valid for 24 hours, for one computer. The PC makes its own key, which never leaves it.
Reset registration	Head office lets the same terminal be set up again, for example after Windows was reinstalled. The terminal keeps its code, BIR permit and OR series; what the old set-up had not sent is kept in a separate file, never deleted.
Sync	The terminal sending its records to head office and fetching new settings, every 15 seconds while online.
Offline window (36 hours)	Offline, a person can sign in at a terminal only if they signed in online on that terminal in the last 36 hours. A terminal that has not received settings for more than 36 hours stops taking payments until it syncs, because it cannot know the current fees.
Four-eyes rule	An approval must come from a different person from the one who asked: the branch manager signs with their own password. The same goes for counting a kiosk box: the person who collected it cannot count it.

7. Security basics

These rules protect TPPA's money, the customers' data and you.

- **Use only your own account.** Never sign in for someone else, and never let anyone work under your name. Every action is recorded with the name of the person signed in, in the audit log, which can never be edited.
- **Never share your password.** Not with a colleague, not with your manager, not with IT. An approval (a void, a cash difference, a refund) is given by the branch manager typing their own password on the screen; nobody else types it.
- **Lock the screen when you leave the counter.** In the teller app press `F12`. The app also locks by itself after 10 minutes without use; your password unlocks it and nothing is lost. In the console, sign out when you leave the computer.
- **Five wrong passwords lock the account for 15 minutes.** After that it unlocks by itself, or an administrator unlocks it. Forgot your password? Ask an administrator to reset it; nobody can reset their own.
- **Keep your phone and recovery codes apart.** If you use two-step sign-in, store the recovery codes somewhere safe, not on the phone.
- **Report anything strange at once:** a receipt you did not print, a screen asking for a password in an unusual place, a kiosk door open with nobody from TPPA there. See the Troubleshooting guide for who to call.

8. Which guide to read next

You are	Read
The owner or a super admin	Super admin guide (01), then the Admin guide (02)
A head-office administrator	Admin guide (02)
In Accounting	Accounting guide (03)
A branch manager	Branch manager guide (04) and Teller guide (05)
A teller	Teller guide (05)
A kiosk custodian	Kiosk custodian guide (06) and Kiosk guide (07)
IT	IT and set-up guide (09) and Troubleshooting guide (08)
Anyone with a problem	Troubleshooting guide (08)